



Training Plan

Rory Bradshaw

Intro to workout plan

Hi Nick,

Welcome to your Strong + Flexible workout programme!

As you will see, this programme is designed with strength and flexibility in mind, so you can build a mobile body that performs and feels great to live in.

Strength training can create tightness and be limiting for flexibility gains, but the strength exercises I have chosen in this programme apply large ranges of motion in order to simultaneously improve your mobility and strength. The flexibility exercises included are all ones I have found to be very beneficial for myself and clients in the past and I'm excited for you to get stuck into them!

Things I have prepared for you has taken into account :

- Your goals.
- The priority at which I think each goal should be addressed. Often there is a need for periodisation of goals. So what is of high priority in the beginning can be secondary or non-important in 3 months time.
- The intensity that's appropriate for you at that stage.
- The frequency of training which will depend on your availability.

The Phase 1 programme:

Phase 1 of this programme typically lasts for 6 weeks and by the end of it you will be very comfortable at performing the movements involved. It will be about getting a higher number of reps in of each exercise and teaching the body the movement patterns required to then progress your strength in later phases. Please study each session before you go to perform it to save you time and ensure you are clear on what you need to do.

Based on the information I have and what we've discussed, I've designed it for your needs and goals, however there will be a feeling out process to begin with where we can discuss how easily you will be able to

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implement it considering your time/space/access to equipment and I can make changes to suite you, as well as if the variations I have assigned to you are suitable for your where you're currently at in your training.

Once you have received the program if you think any of the above aspects need to be discussed further please get in touch with me within the next 12 hours. If needed I will make any modifications necessary for you to start as soon as possible, for example removing the number of sets/ reps (total volume) or replacing some exercises.

It might be the case you need to invest in a little equipment such as gymnastic rings, yoga blocks or a small weight for example. Please let me know if this is not possible. I highly recommend buying some liquid chalk if you have not already got some as this will really help you with any exercise that places a demand on your grip strength (e.g. hangs, pull ups etc.)

When you begin doing the workouts - make sure to press 'start workout' in the app so you can log your progress and I can see it too!

Progressive Overload:

Throughout this training Phase, you will apply progressive overload, which is a core principle of strength and fitness training that involves gradually increasing the demands placed on your muscles and nervous system over time. Along with your consistent effort and discipline, it will be essential to your progress throughout this phase.

Here's how progressive overload can be applied to this training program:

1. **Gradually increase the weight you move each session:** For example, if you do 3x10 reps of 50kg squat in week 1, you could aim for 3x10 reps 52.5kg squat in week 2 or 3. This gradual increase stimulates muscle growth and strength gains.
2. **Adding Repetitions or Sets:** Another approach is to perform more reps or sets of an exercise. If you do 3x10 reps of 50kg squat in week 1, you could try to do 3x11 reps of 50kg squat in week 2 or 3.
3. **Adding a longer hold time or moving to a harder variation:** For some exercises in this programme you may be holding a stretch. You can make this harder each week by holding the stretch for a longer period of time than the week before or choosing a harder variation of the stretch.

Any questions around how to implement progressive overload to your training or the exercises I have prescribed you, please ask me :)

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Scheduling: Life changes all the time and so do our schedules and the time we have to train. This programme can be done in the time that you have and does not have to fit within 1 week. I suggest you plan out your week ahead of time and input when you plan to do each workout and aim to complete all the workouts within 7-10 days but if this is unrealistic please speak to me and we can adjust your plan.

Weekly check-ins:

Your check-in day and time will be each THURSDAY by midday.

To submit your checkin, press the '+' icon on your app home screen and press +add check in.

Please complete the checkin form in as much detail as possible and I would also love to see some videos of you performing the exercises which you can send me using the message function in the coaching app. Your check-in day has been assigned to you to allow me sufficient time to focus on your development and it allows me to get back to you as quickly as possible. As long as you report on your assigned day, I will always aim to respond to you within 48 hours (but hopefully much less!).

Please stick to your reporting day for your updates and I will get back to you within 48 hours.

If you are unable to report for a particular week, the best thing to do is send your update the day before (Wednesday). Obviously any quick questions throughout the week are welcome through the messaging tool on the App but you'll get the most thorough response with your weekly updates.

Instagram:

If you use Instagram, please send me a DM and I will add you to my close friends list where I occasionally share extra tips and advice for my online clients.

Recording:

Please make sure to record yourself performing each of the exercises and send them to me to on the day of our first check in (Thursday), so that I can provide you with feedback and adjustments where needed. You do not need to do this every week, but it is very helpful if you do it at the start of a new phase before you get stuck into the programme.

The quality of the videos/pictures should be as good as possible for me to be able to assess the quality of the movement and advise you accordingly. If the following 3 factors are taken into account the images/

videos are usually good :

1. Good lighting
2. Clean background
3. The use of the same location
4. Always the same angle

The Meal Plan:

I have prescribed you a meal plan based on what you defined as your goals. This can either be followed rigidly or as a guide. It is a tool to support you with your diet that I hope you will find helpful.

I love food and I do not follow a specific diet, but I always follow the below rules to stay nourished and fuel my training, whilst still leaving a bit of space to enjoy some of the 'naughty' choices.

The diet I choose is one that opts for foods we humans have been eating for thousands of years. REAL whole foods, rather than modern processed foods that are high in sugar, salt and additives. Below are some food types I recommend, though of course if you follow a vege/vegan diet or have allergies there are other healthy approaches to take too:

- Meat (the higher quality the better), fish, eggs (yes the yolks are great too!)
- Vegetables - nobody ever got overweight eating too many vegetables! Fermented veges are also great for your gut health.
- Fruits - nature's gift to us all in my opinion.
- Nuts - raw and not roasted if possible
- Safe Starches - Rice, Potatoes, Yams, plantain
- Dairy - Mature Cheese, Butter.

Example Meals and snacks:

- Vegetable omelette with cheese
- Fruit and nut snack mix
- Meat stew with plantain and rice

My top tips with diet:

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- Earn your carbs - on the days you are training, you can be more generous to yourself with the number of carbohydrates you consume. Bear in mind I tend to use carbs as my primary energy source instead of fats.
- High protein - try to include at least 10g of protein per meal and aim to consume 1g of protein for every 1kg of your bodyweight daily as a minimum. For example, I weigh around 90kg at the moment so I am aiming to consume 135g (90x1.5) protein per day. The meal plan should help you with this.
- Hydration - make sure to drink 2-4 litres of water per day. I also really recommend consuming electrolytes on the days you train or sweat a lot.
- Avoid processed foods **as much as possible but still enjoy your life! Try to eat foods our ancestors would recognise and avoid most foods they wouldn't recognise.** This includes excessive added sugar - aim to consume most sugars from normal fruits.

Different diet approaches:

I have tried different approaches over the years and found these to work well:

Intermittent Fasting:

This can be done either daily or a few days per week. The benefit of fasting is that it can help to set your circadian rhythm (aka your biological clock), which when in a healthy and regular pattern, will improve your sleep quality, mood, energy levels and reduce your risk of chronic diseases like diabetes or cardiovascular disease.

I usually fast for 16 hours and eat within an 8 hour window 3-4 days per week. During the fast I still drink water, black coffee and tea (all zero calorie drinks).

This is also a great tool for weight management if that is a concern to you, as you will be eating for less hours of the day and likely pay more control over what you consume.

Regular meals:

I'm also a big fan of eating smaller regular portions if training regularly, typically 5 meals per day (where 'snacks' are considered a meal). This approach works especially well for building muscle and strength or maintaining muscle mass.

Considerations:

- Nick, I am confident that if you commit to training with me and the programmes I will make for you, your aims of building muscle mass and giving attention to all areas of your body across multiple movement patterns to build overall strength and flexibility will happen!

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- You mentioned your job is stationary - we can talk more about this but I have put a quick movement routine in your 'lessons' feature that may help :)
- I understand you have a small gym in your apartment so may have limited access to some equipment - let me know if any of the exercises I have given you are not suitable and I can amend them.
- The lower back pain you describe down your left hammy is something to keep an eye, let me know if that improves/gets worse/stays the same as you train

Don't forget:

To hit the 'start workout' button when you begin your session so you can track your sets for each exercise. This will also allow me to see what you do each workout.

Remember:

As your coach, I'm here to guide you, give you structure and keep you accountable. You'll get as much out of coaching as you put in and I am here to guide you through the process. I'm really excited to see how you get on with this programme and for the progress you'll make.

It can feel a little overwhelming getting all this information at the start of our training, but take your time and know that with time you will get a grasp of what to do and how to implement this into your schedule. As always, I'm here to help so please let me know if you have any questions.

LET'S GO 💪

Rory

Program overview

Strength + Mobility: Lower Body

EXERCISE

Treadmill Power Walk

1 sets reps

*"*This exercise can also be substituted for any other form of moderate intensity cardio such as cycling, rowing or the cross trainer. I usually walk to the gym to do my workouts so treat that as my warmup.*"*

The purpose here is to raise your internal body temperature, elevate your heart rate and prepare to move in the workout.

It is not an essential part of the workout and should you be limited on time and feel warm and able to get straight into the rest of the warmup exercises then go for it and feel free to skip this part.

"

Leg swings

1 sets 10 reps

"Hold onto a solid surface with one arm.

Swing legs in three directions for up to 10 reps on each leg per direction.

For the forward and side swing movements, you could throw in a hold on the final rep of 10-30 seconds, trying to lift the leg as high as you can in front of you or to the side, to build up strength in this position. If doing a hold, remember to breath and lift the foot as high as possible.

Try to keep the legs almost straight but with a slight bend.

Don't kick so hard you hurt your hamstrings or groin, start gentle and get more energetic with the movement each swing. "

Lunge rotations

1 sets 6-10 reps

"Setup:

Adopt a lunge position on the floor and imagine a string pulling you up to the ceiling/sky from the crown

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of your head.

Cues:

Breathe in and as you exhale twist as far to one side as is comfortable and as you inhale come back to face the centre with your torso.

Perform 6-10 reps on one side then include the hold, again using your exhales to twist a little further as you push the back of the hand into the outer thigh. Repeat both sides. "

Superset

3 rounds

"This superset trains two movements together in order to save time. The exercises work well together as a pair. Perform the superset for 3 sets in total. Perform each set of exercise A and B back to back with a 90 second rest between the sets. So do one set of exercise A, rest for 90 seconds do one set of exercise B, rest 90 seconds, do one set of exercise A etc.. "

Split Squat

8-10 reps rest 90 sec

"Split Squat cues:

- 1. Keep your chest up and shoulders back to maintain a neutral spine.*
- 2. Lower your body slowly and under control*
- 3. As you ascend from the split squat position, focus on pushing through the toes and heel of the front foot. This helps activate the muscles in your glutes and hamstrings and promotes better balance. Avoid pushing primarily through your toes, as it may place unnecessary strain on your knees.*
- 4. Try to keep the back leg as straight as possible to get stretch on the hip flexor*
- 5. Squeeze those glutes! This protects your lower back..*
- 6. Breathing - Breathe in slowly as you lower yourself into the split squat position. Exhale as you push yourself back up to the starting position."*

Romanian Deadlift (barbell/dumbbell)

8-10 reps rest 90 sec

"The Romanian Deadlift (RDL) works the hamstrings, glutes, lower back, and core muscles. It can be done with a barbell or dumbbells.

As your mobility improves you can also stand on a step to allow you to move further through the range of the movement. Though start standing on the floor first.

Cues:

Stand with your feet hip-width apart, toes pointing forward.

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Place the barbell/dumbbell in front of you, close to your shins.

Grip the weight with an overhand grip (if your grip is a limiting factor you could also use hand straps here).

You hands should be slightly wider than shoulder-width apart or shoulder width depending on what is more comfortable.

Grip the weight TIGHT while keeping your arms straight.

Engage your lats by squeezing your shoulder together and drawing them down your back.

Maintain a slight bend in your knees.

Initiate the movement by pushing your hips back while maintaining a flat back and a neutral spine. Imagine pushing your glutes back towards the wall behind you.

Keep your spine in a neutral position throughout the movement. Avoid rounding your back by keeping your chest up and shoulders back.

Lower the weight by hinging at the hips, allowing it to slide down your thighs. and shins.

Continue to push your hips back until you feel a stretch in your hamstrings.

Your knees should maintain a slight bend to keep hamstrings engaged, but the movement primarily comes from your hips. Your knees will bend less than a conventional deadlift.

Feel the stretch in your hamstrings, and then engage your hamstrings, glutes, and lower back to reverse the movement as you thrust hips forward.

Return to Starting Position by pushing your hips forward as you stand up, bringing your torso back to an upright position.

"

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Rest 90 sec before continuing

Superset

3 rounds

"This superset trains two movements together in order to save time. The exercises work well together as a pair. Perform the superset for 3 sets in total. Perform each set of exercise A and B back to back with a 90 second rest between the sets. So do one set of exercise A, rest for 90 seconds do one set of exercise B, rest 90 seconds, do one set of exercise A etc.. "

Wide leg squat / horse stance

8-10 reps rest 90 sec

"Setup:

Heel-toe feet a part using the three step demonstration in video to find the right distance.

Toes should be pointing slightly turned out.

Keep your back straight, chest up, and shoulder blades depressed.

Keep an upright posture throughout the stance, avoiding leaning forward or backward.

Begin bending your knees, lowering your body towards the ground.

Aim to lower yourself to a position where your thighs are parallel to the ground, if not lower as you get more mobile.

Focus on posterior pelvic tilt, so tilt your hips BACK.

Ensure your knees are tracking over your toes in the same direction your toes are pointing and not collapsing inward.

Press your heels firmly into the ground throughout the movement.

Avoid lifting your heels or shifting your weight onto the balls of your feet if possible, though you can place a small weight or shelf under your heels if it helps you go deeper in the movement.

Pause in the bottom position for 3 seconds and contract glutes and quads.

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Barbell or kettlebell weight can be added to increase the exercise intensity. "

Cossack Squats

8-10 reps rest 90 sec

"Split Squat Cues:

- 1. Adopt a wide stance with toes pointing outward at an angle of about 45 degrees. This stance will allow you to move smoothly into the lateral squat position.*
- 2. Shift your bodyweight to one leg as you begin to bend that knee and lower your body to the side. Keep the other leg straight with the heel firmly planted on the ground. The straight leg will remain active during the movement so if you can, keep the quad and hamstring muscles engaged.*
- 3. Avoid lifting the heel of the foot of the leg you are squatting on, as this may cause balance issues and reduce the effectiveness of the exercise. Go to the deepest range of the movement that you can whilst keeping the heel grounded. You could place a small step/weight under your heel to elevate it if this helps you go deeper into the movement without it lifting.*
- 4. Try to keep an upright torso with your chest lifted during the entire movement.*
- 5. Like always, move with control and gradually increase your range of motion as your mobility improves.*

Balancing - you can use an external surface to help keep your torso upright or extend you arms in from of you to help you balance as you perform the movement. "

Rest 90 sec before continuing

Superset

2 rounds

"Depending on access to equipment, try to perform these two exercises b2b. "

Knee raises (bodyweight -> weighted)

5-20 reps rest 60 sec

"Starting Position: Grip the bars firmly with both hands, and let your body hang freely. Your arms should be fully extended, and your feet should not touch the ground.

Engage Your Core: Before beginning the movement, engage your core muscles by drawing your belly button in towards your spine. This will help stabilize your torso throughout the exercise.

Pelvis: Adopt a position of posterior pelvic tilt to engage the core by tilting your pelvis and tailbone forwards. Try to maintain this position throughout the movement for maximum core engagement.

Shoulder Position: Keep your shoulders down and away from your ears. Avoid shrugging or tensing your neck and shoulder muscles.

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Hip Flexion: Initiate the movement by bending your knees and lifting them towards your chest. Focus on using your lower abdominal muscles and hip flexors to bring your knees up.

Knee Raise: Continue lifting your knees as high as you can with control. Aim to bring your thighs as close to your chest as possible without compromising your form.

Controlled Lowering: Lower your knees back down to the starting position in a controlled manner. Avoid letting your legs swing freely.

If this is too challenging do it with one leg at a time. If it is too easy, use an added weight by placing a small dumbbell between your feet.

Tip - try to angle your big toes together so they are touching and your heels are apart (not valid for single leg version).

Maintain Stability: Throughout the movement, keep your upper body stable and avoid swinging or using momentum to lift your legs."

Locust pose (3 Variations)

8-12 reps rest 60 sec

"Lay flat on your front and choose one of the three variations to perform.

The variations get more intense each time, but choose one in which you feel suites the intensity required to strengthen your lower and upper back.

Variation 1: arms extended behind you with thumbs facing up (shoulders in external rotation)

Variation 2: arms bent at 90 degrees, thumbs facing the sky, retract shoulder blades as you lift up.

Variation 3: arms extended ahead of you with thumbs facing up

Cues for all variations:

1. Take a breath in and as you breathe out lift your chest as high as you can and lift your feet off the floor and thighs off the floor as much as possible (they may not even come off the floor when first trying this exercise. Try to create a curved C-shape with your body from your feet to you head.

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ALWAYS squeeze your glutes hard in this position to protect your lower back and build strength.

Perform for reps but as in the video, hold the top position for 2-3 seconds each rep.

You may wish to decompress your spine after performing this exercise by trying a child's pose or rag doll pose. "

Half Splits (dynamic)

1 sets 120 sec

"Stretching the Hamstring:

Inhale and gently shift your hips back, hinging at your hips.

Continue to slide your front foot forward until you feel a stretch in the hamstring of the extended leg. If you feel a strong pull in the back of your knee, bend your knee slightly to reduce the strain.

Place your hands on the yoga blocks for support. You can adjust the height of the blocks to find the most comfortable and effective position.

Maintain Length in the Spine:

Lengthen your spine by reaching your chest forward and keeping your back straight.

Avoid rounding your back or collapsing your chest.

Flex the foot up and down if it feels good or hold the stretch in a position of toes point forward or up to the ceiling

Relax and Breathe:

Relax into the stretch and breathe deeply. As you exhale, you may find that you can deepen the stretch slightly.

Hold one set for 30-120 seconds

"

Laying Figure 4 stretch

1 sets 120 sec

"Leg Positioning:

Cross one ankle over the opposite knee, forming a "figure 4" shape with your legs.

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Flex the foot of the leg that is elevated to protect your knee joint.

Grip:

Draw your legs towards you by either gripping the back of your thigh or your shin with fingers interlocked. At the same time keep pressing your tailbone into the floor and don't allow lower back to lift too high off the floor.

This should create a stretch in the hip and glute of the crossed leg.

You can also gently push the knee of the crossed leg towards the floor to increase the stretch.

Repeat on both sides.

Hold stretch for 30-120 seconds.

"

Quad + hip flexor stretches

1 sets 120 sec

"Choose the progression that feels comfortable for you and hold the stretch for up to 120 seconds per set. "

Elongated Exhales

1 sets reps

"Elongated exhales are an amazing way to activate your parasympathetic nervous system aka your 'rest and digest' state.

They're a simple but very effective tool you can use when you are feeling stressed/anxious to reset yourself, but are also great to do at the end of a workout to start the recovery process immediately by taking your body and nervous system down from its high energy state from the workout.

Cues:

Sit or lay down (If sitting find a tall spine or sit against a wall if it helps).

Close your eyes or take your gaze to a fixed spot e.g. the wall in front of you.

Focus on the sensations of breathing (eg air coming into your nose, descending down into your lungs and back out again).

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For up to 10-30 rounds of breath, exhale for twice the length of your inhale.

For example you could:

- Inhale for a count of 2, exhale for a count of 4*
- Inhale for a count of 3, exhale for a count of 6*

The number is less important, it's more important that the exhale is more prolonged than the inhale.

This signals to your nervous system it is okay to relax :) "

Cardio + Mobility: Upper Body

EXERCISE

Assault Bike (Fan bike)

2 sets 4 min rest 180 sec

*"*This can be substituted for another cardio machine at the gym if there is not an Assault Bike**

Each set consists of 4 minutes.

You will perform a 20 second sprint, followed by 10 seconds of rest, throughout the 4 minutes.

In total each set you will therefore do 8x20 seconds sprints.

In the sprints work HARD and you will build a great cardiovascular base and your anaerobic capacity will improve.

You can add extra sets if you have the energy and time. "

Vinyasa options (x3)

2 sets 5 reps rest 60 sec

"Instructions contained in video, let me know if you have any questions :)"

Choose the option suitable for you.

Down dog cues: you are trying to create an inverted V shape with your body.

- Feet and hands about hip width apart.

- Straighten legs as much as possible sending heels towards floor. Bending knees is absolutely fine, you should feel a stretch in the backs of the legs.

- PUSH the floor away with both hands to elevate the shoulder blades and wrap your elbows in by internally rotating your shoulders (imagine squeezing an orange in your armpit) and this should help engage your lats and shoulder muscles

- Active fingers - if someone came to you and tried to lift your finger up from the floor they should find this difficult - this is how you know your fingers are active.

- Look at the space between your feet and ensure a neutral spine from top of head to base of spine. "

Neck stretch sequence

1 sets 5 min

"Hold each stretch for 30-60 seconds.

Be gentle with all these stretches to avoid straining your neck. "

Lat stretch

1 sets 60 sec

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"See video for instructions and let me know if you have any questions :)"

Corskcrew Shoulders

1 sets 20 reps

"Perform until you start to feel the a slight burn in the shoulders."

Option to add weights to the hands to make it more challenging. I recommend 1-5kg per hand.

Rotate the arm in the shoulder joint as far as it will go without pain. Each arm will be rotated the opposite way to the other each rep so you know if you're doing it correctly if you look at one arm and the palm is facing up and you look to the other arm and the palm is facing down. "

Shoulder dislocations

2 sets 6-8 reps rest 60 sec

"A mobility exercise that helps improve shoulder flexibility and range of motion."

By moving your arms in a full circular motion you will use the full capacity of your shoulder joint.

Cues:

Try to elevate your shoulder blades as you lift up the band/bar then as you draw it behind you, retract and depress your shoulder blades.

Tip: shake out your arms between sets to help you recover for the next set."

Rest 60 sec before continuing

Cuban rotations

2 sets 8-10 reps rest 60 sec

"A great shoulder mobility exercise that targets the rotator cuff muscles."

Cues:

Engage Your Core: Brace your core muscles to stabilize your spine throughout the movement. Keep your torso upright and avoid arching your lower back.

Rotational Movement: As you rotate in the movement, retract your shoulder blade back. Aim to keep your elbows at shoulder height.

The emphasis with this exercise should be on maintaining proper form and control rather than using heavy weights."

Rest 60 sec before continuing

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Hang (passive -> active)

2 sets 30 sec rest 60 sec

"Passive hanging from a bar is a beneficial exercise for stretching and decompressing the shoulder joint and spine, improving grip strength, and promoting overall shoulder health.

Active hanging builds strength in the shoulders and upper back as well as improves overhead mobility in the shoulder flexion movement.

Variation 1: Supported passive hang. Find a bar or rings of a height that allows you to have both feet on the floor. With hands shoulder width apart, grip the bar and lower yourself into a hang position with the feet supporting you as little as possible. Be light on the toes so you build strength in the shoulders.

Variation 2: Make the above harder by picking up one foot so your shoulders have to work harder

Variation 3: Hang passively with both feet lifted

Variation 4: Make the hang active by bringing your knees in front of you and engage your core by adopting posterior pelvic tilt (hips and tailbone thrust forward and rounding in lower back)

Variation 5: Make this active hang harder by locking out the legs "

Rest 60 sec before continuing

Superset

2 rounds

"Perform these exercises back to back with 60 secs rest between each set. "

Shoulder/upper back opener (bent arm -> straight arm)

6-10 reps rest 60 sec

"Perform the bent arm variation followed by the straight arm variation.

In each variation perform 6-10 reps/pulses with control.

For the hold, go further into it each time you exhale and hold for 30 secs total. "

Overhead pullovers

6-10 reps rest 60 sec

"Perform for reps and then include a hold of 10-30 seconds on the final rep.

Remember - elbows IN! "

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Shoulder stretch sequence

1 sets reps

"This sequence contains 5 shoulder stretches that you can try and choose the ones that feel very beneficial."

Complete sequence in full for 1-2 sets. Hold each stretch for 30-120 seconds depending on time.

Let me know if you have any questions :) "

Run 2 (Interval session)

EXERCISE

Superset

1
round

"Perform bodyweight variations of these exercises as a warmup before your run. "

Leg swings

10 reps

"Hold onto a solid surface with one arm.

Swing legs in three directions for up to 10 reps on each leg per direction.

For the forward and side swing movements, you could throw in a hold on the final rep of 10-30 seconds, trying to lift the leg as high as you can in front of you or to the side, to build up strength in this position. If doing a hold, remember to breath and lift the foot as high as possible.

Try to keep the legs almost straight but with a slight bend.

Don't kick so hard you hurt your hamstrings or groin, start gentle and get more energetic with the movement each swing. "

Hip Hinges

10 reps

"Hip Hinges:

The main goal is to use your posterior chain (glutes and hamstrings) to power the movement.

Try the variations and see which one feels good at this stage. Options include:

- feet shoulder width a part or wide*
- knees bent or straight*
- bodyweight/weight added*
- no pause/ isometric pause at bottom of each rep*

Cues:

- 1. Stand Tall with Neutral Spine.*
- 2. Engage your core muscles to stabilize your spine. Ensure your back is in a neutral position, neither rounded nor overly arched.*

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3. Initiate the Movement from the Hips so as you start the hip hinge, push your hips back and lead forward with your chest.

4. Maintain a Soft Bend in the Knees unless you are very flexible and can keep the legs straight whilst hinging forward without rounding in the lower back.

5. Try to maintain a straight line from the crown of your head to your hips. "

Split Squat

10 reps

"Split Squat cues:

1. Keep your chest up and shoulders back to maintain a neutral spine.

2. Lower your body slowly and under control

3. As you ascend from the split squat position, focus on pushing through the toes and heel of the front foot. This helps activate the muscles in your glutes and hamstrings and promotes better balance. Avoid pushing primarily through your toes, as it may place unnecessary strain on your knees.

4. Try to keep the back leg as straight as possible to get stretch on the hip flexor

5. Squeeze those glutes! This protects your lower back..

6. Breathing - Breathe in slowly as you lower yourself into the split squat position. Exhale as you push yourself back up to the starting position."

Running

5 sets 800 m

rest 120 sec

"5 efforts of 800m with a 2 minute rest. You can either rest completely or adopt a slower run to recover.

Try to find a nice route or better still a park or area with grass to do this on. Alternatively you could use a treadmill, ideally a curved running machine at the gym.

Each session you can add 100m to each set:

Session 1: 5x800m (4km total)

Session 2: 5x900m (4.5km total)

Session 3: 5x1km (5km total)

Session 4: 5x1.1km (5.5km total)

Session 5: 5x1.2km (6km total)"

Superset

1
round

"Post run stretch to open up the body"

Laying Figure 4 stretch

10-15 breaths

"Leg Positioning:

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Cross one ankle over the opposite knee, forming a "figure 4" shape with your legs.

Flex the foot of the leg that is elevated to protect your knee joint.

Grip:

Draw your legs towards you by either gripping the back of your thigh or your shin with fingers interlocked. At the same time keep pressing your tailbone into the floor and don't allow lower back to lift too high off the floor.

This should create a stretch in the hip and glute of the crossed leg.

You can also gently push the knee of the crossed leg towards the floor to increase the stretch.

Repeat on both sides.

Hold stretch for 30-120 seconds.

"

Calf Stretch (passive -> active -> weighted)

15 breaths

"Perform the passive calves stretch for 1-2 sets (depending on time), then perform the single/double leg active stretch after for 1-2 sets (again depending on how much time you have).

Passive calves stretch: Hold for 2 minutes on each side per set.

Single or double leg active stretch: Choose one which feels better for you. Perform 5-10 hinges per set and hold a small weight whilst you do the hinges if it feels good. Once you have done the hinges, add in a hold of 10-30 seconds at the end of the set, going deeper into the stretch every exhale.

Of course if doing single legs, repeat on both sides for the same duration with the same weight.

All information within the instructional video. "

Leg lift hamstring stretch (weighted and non-weighted)

15 breaths

*"*do the bodyweight variation of this stretch**

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Personal Workout Plan

Setup:

Have a sturdy box/bench/shelf in front of you. Stand facing the elevated surface with your feet hip-width apart. Hold a dumbbell or kettlebell in one hand.

Place the foot of the leg you want to stretch onto the elevated surface.

Toes of the stretching leg can be pointed up to the ceiling or pointed forwards.

Initiate the Movement:

Inhale and begin the exercise by hinging at your hips, sending them back and leaning forward.

Keep a slight bend in the knee of the foot on the box and a soft bend in the knee of the standing leg. Straighten out the knees if it feels okay and engage quad muscles.

Stretching the Hamstring:

As you lean forward, focus on feeling the stretch in the hamstring of the leg on the box.

Reach your free hand towards the floor or allow the weight to hang down to increase the stretch.

Maintain Control:

Avoid rounding your back or excessively arching your lower back during the stretch. Try to keep a neutral spine and lead with lower belly as you hinge forward rather than chest. As you fold forward, think of pulling your thigh bone towards the hip joint.

Breathing:

Your breath is really helpful for this stretch. Inhale as you initiate the movement by hinging at your hips. Exhale as you deepen the stretch by leaning forward."

Strength + Mobility: Upper Body

EXERCISE

Treadmill Power Walk

1 sets 10 min

*"*This exercise can also be substituted for any other form of moderate intensity cardio such as cycling, rowing or the cross trainer. I usually walk to the gym to do my workouts so treat that as my warmup.*"*

The purpose here is to raise your internal body temperature, elevate your heart rate and prepare to move in the workout.

It is not an essential part of the workout and should you be limited on time and feel warm and able to get straight into the rest of the warmup exercises then go for it and feel free to skip this part.

"

Rest 30 sec before continuing

Wrist mobility (9 movements)

1 sets 2 min

"The instructional video is an overview of a wrist mobility and stretch sequence containing 9 variations.

Depending on your wrist strength and mobility different variations will feel more/less challenging.

I recommend choosing 2-5 of these movements and performing them in one go, spending 20-60 seconds performing each of the chosen wrist exercises, depending on how they feel.

For those with a dynamic movement (e.g. wrist rocks with fists clenched or palm lifts), move GENTLY though the movement. To make them harder, lean you shoulders more forwards to add the intensity of demand onto your wrists.

To finish or within the set, shake out your hands and avoid creating any pain in your wrists.

Remember, this is a WARM-UP, not a workout. Do enough to warm up and stretch your wrist, but not enough to hurt or fatigue them. You don't want them tired before you train.

You just want strength, mobility, and warmth."

Rest 30 sec before continuing

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Cow/cat variations

1 sets 20 breaths

"Choose a variation that feels pleasant for opening up the muscles around your spine and across your back. "

Rest 30 sec before continuing

Spinal rotation movements (dynamic + passive)

1 sets 10 reps

"Choose a variation that feels good and remember to perform on both sides.

Combine repetitions with a hold in the twist position of 15-30 seconds at the end of the set if it feels comfortable.

Twist further on your exhales. "

Rest 30 sec before continuing

Scapula movements

1 sets 40 reps

"Perform these movements for up to 10 reps per movement (so up to 40 total):

Retraction

Protraction

Elevation

Depression

"

Rest 30 sec before continuing

Hanging shrugs

1 sets 10 reps

"Starting Position:

Hang from a pull-up bar or rings with an overhand grip (palms facing away from you).

Allow your body to fully extend, and your feet should not touch the ground. HOWEVER If this exercise is too challenging to perform with feet off the floor, you should place a small step or box under you and place your toes or feet onto it JUST enough to support you in the position as you do the shrugs. Try to use as little support from the feet as possible so you build your strength in your shoulders.

Engage Core and Maintain Body Alignment:

Tilt your pelvis forwards (anterior tilt) to engage core and build shoulder mobility.

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Maintain a straight body alignment from head to heels. Avoid excessive swinging or arching of your back.

Initiate the Movement:

Begin the exercise by actively pulling your shoulder blades down and back.

Imagine you are trying to squeeze a pen between your shoulder blades.

Shrug Movement:

Reverse the movement by elevating your shoulder blades towards your ears, contracting your upper back muscles.

Keep your arms straight throughout the movement.

Avoid fully relaxing your shoulders at the bottom to maintain tension on the muscles.

Focus on the muscles in your upper back to lift and lower your shoulder blades."

Rest 30 sec before continuing

Superset 1

3 rounds

"This superset trains a push and pull movement together in order to save time. The exercises work well together as a pair because they work antagonistic muscle groups. As your muscles used in the push movement recover, you perform the pull movement and vis versa. Perform the superset for 3 sets in total. Perform each set of exercise A and B back to back with a 90 second rest between the sets. So do one set of exercise A, rest for 90 seconds do one set of exercise B, rest 90 seconds, do one set of exercise A etc.. "

Push ups variations (incline -> dumbbell -> rings)

8-10 reps rest 90 sec

"Variation 1 - incline push ups:

Place a sturdy bench or elevated surface in front of you. Assume a push-up position with your hands shoulder-width apart and resting on the edge of the bench. Your palms should be placed firmly on the bench and fingers facing forward.

Step your feet back to extend your body into a plank position with your toes on the ground and your body forming a straight line from head to heels.

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Engage Core and Maintain Alignment:

Keep your body in a straight line from head to heels throughout the exercise. Avoid arching or sagging your back.

Initiate the Movement: Inhale and begin to lower your chest toward the bench by bending your elbows. Keep your elbows at approximately a 45-degree angle to your body, pointing slightly backward rather than directly out to the sides.

Descent: Lower your body under control until your chest lightly touches or comes close to the bench.

Push Back Up: Exhale and push through your palms to extend your arms, lifting your body back to the starting position. Keep your body in a straight line as you press upward.

Control the Movement: Avoid using momentum to push yourself up. Focus on using the strength of your chest, shoulders, and triceps to lift your body.

Try to lower slowly and push explosively back up.

Variation 2 - push ups using parallel bars/dumbbells:

This variation allows for a greater range of motion with the exercise and a greater stretch on the chest. Cues are similar to variation 1 but make sure elbows don't flare out as you perform the push up, keep them tucked to your ribs.

Variation 3 - rings push ups:

This is the hardest variation. Elevating feet on a box is not essential and this can be done from the floor, but elevating the feet will allow you to move through a greater range of motion as you perform the push up movement by giving more room for your torso to descend down. At first this exercise will feel very shaky using the rings but you will soon adapt and become stable.

At the top of the rep bring the hands on the rings close together and as you descend widen them enough to allow your torso to move down to the floor.

For a small adjustment to make it harder and build big shoulder strength, turn the palms out at the top of the rep/externally rotate your shoulders and pause in this top position for a second between each rep.

"

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Bodyweight Row -> Arc Rows

8-10 reps rest 90 sec

"Setup:

Adjust the rings/TRX so that they are hanging at about waist height.

Grab the rings in a pronated grip (palms facing the ground) and take a step back to create tension in the straps while keeping your body at a slight angle.

Adjust the intensity - you can decide the angle you wish to use. The more angled away your torso is from the rings, the harder the exercise and the closer (ie the more upright you are) the easier. So try out a few angles and choose the one which you can maintain to do the reps prescribed.

Engage Core and Set Shoulder Position:

Engage your core muscles set your shoulder blades by pulling them down and back (depress and retract). This creates a stable base for your shoulders.

Initiate the Movement:

Start with your arms fully extended, hands holding the rings/TRX handles, and your body leaning back at a slight angle.

Initiate the movement by pulling your chest up towards the handles, leading with your elbows. DRIVE your elbows back HARD.

Rowing Motion:

As you pull your chest towards the handles, focus on squeezing your shoulder blades together.

Imagine you are trying to pull your chest to the handles while keeping your body in a straight line.

Full Contraction:

Continue pulling as high as you can.

Controlled Return:

In a controlled manner, gradually extend your arms to return to the starting position, allowing your shoulder blades to separate.

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Keep tension in the straps throughout the movement, avoiding slack.

Breathing:

Exhale as you pull your chest towards the rings. Inhale as you slowly extend your arms to return to the starting position.

ARC PULLS PROGRESSION:

1: Grab the rings and set your feet into position. The more parallel you get to the ground, the harder this movement becomes.

2: Squeeze the shoulders BACK and push the rings DOWN with straight arms. Then, drive your elbows BACK to go up.

3: Do NOT voluntarily lower down. Instead, PUSH the rings DOWN further towards your feet and as you do, the leverage will get worse and eventually, you will start to fall. When that happens, resist as MUCH as you can and that will let you get a maximal eccentric.

As you get stronger, get more parallel to the ground and touch the ring lower and lower on your torso!"

Rest 60 sec before continuing

Superset 2

3 rounds

"This superset trains a push and pull movement together in order to save time. The exercises work well together as a pair because they work antagonistic muscle groups. As your muscles used in the push movement recover, you perform the pull movement and vis versa. Perform the superset for 3 sets in total. Perform each set of exercise A and B back to back with a 90 second rest between the sets. So do one set of exercise A, rest for 90 seconds do one set of exercise B, rest 90 seconds, do one set of exercise A etc.. "

Single arm dumbbell press

8-10 reps rest 90 sec

"Setup and cues:

Adopt a lunge position on the floor and hold weight in a neutral grip position.

Drive the planted foot into the floor as you drive the weight up. Try not to let your elbow flare out but keep the weight travelling up and down in a straight line.

Fully extend the arm as you extend it up with the weight.

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Push the weight up on an inhale and lower down with control.

Weight - choose a weight that allows you to meet the repetition goals each set. On the last rep of each set you should be only JUST able to squeeze out the rep or even fail on it. "

Pull up + chin up progressions

8-10 reps rest 90 sec

"Depending on your level of strength, you will choose a different variation (band assisted, unassisted bar pull ups, ring pull ups). The video shows pull up and chin up variations - both are valid and we will work on both during your programme but choose one to stick with for a full phase (1 month).

Variation 1: Band assisted

Setup:

Secure a resistance band around the pull-up bar. Depending on your strength, different levels of resistance band will be required to complete the reps, so you may need to buy a variety to use as you progress.

Step onto the resistance band with one or both feet, depending on what you find more comfortable - just make sure to change the foot between left and right if doing one foot in order to avoid imbalances.

Place hands slightly wider than shoulder-width apart for both pull up and chin up versions.

Hang from the bar with your arms fully extended.

Engage Core and Set Shoulder Position:

Engage your core muscles by tilting your pelvis forward, and angling your feet in front of your legs so that your legs angle diagonally in front of you extending away from your hips.

Set your shoulder blades by pulling them down and back. This creates a solid foundation for your shoulders and helps maintain proper alignment.

Initiate the Movement:

Inhale and start the pull-up by pulling your shoulder blades down and DRIVE your elbows behind you as you come up as if you were elbowing someone behind you.

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Focus on using your upper back muscles and arms to initiate and complete the pull-up.

Full Range of Motion:

Try to pull your chest as close to the bar as possible.

Keep your body in a straight line throughout the movement.

Controlled Descent:

Slowly lower your body back down to the starting position.

Maintain control throughout the descent to engage your muscles effectively.

Pace:

Pull up as explosively as you can and take 2-3 seconds to descend down in the rep.

Breathing:

Exhale as you pull your body upwards. Inhale as you lower your body back down.

Variation 2: Unassisted (cues as above without the band)

Variation 3: Add a weight either between your feet or more preferable is using a weight belt.

Variation 4: Rings chin ups. Cues as above with some extra considerations:

Setup:

Hang the gymnastic rings at a height that allows you to reach them comfortably while standing on the ground.

Initiate the Movement:

Inhale and start the chin-up by pulling your elbows down and back, focusing on engaging your biceps and upper back muscles. Turn the rings as you come up and keep elbows tucked in.

Aim to pull your chin over the height of the rings at the top of the movement.

Keep your wrists neutral and maintain tension in your core.

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Keep your body aligned and avoid swinging."

Rest 90 sec before continuing

Locust pose (3 Variations)

2 sets 8-10 reps rest 90 sec

"Lay flat on your front and choose one of the three variations to perform.

The variations get more intense each time, but choose one in which you feel suites the intensity required to strengthen your lower and upper back.

Variation 1: arms extended behind you with thumbs facing up (shoulders in external rotation)

Variation 2: arms bent at 90 degrees, thumbs facing the sky, retract shoulder blades as you lift up.

Variation 3: arms extended ahead of you with thumbs facing up

Cues for all variations:

1. Take a breath in and as you breathe out lift your chest as high as you can and lift your feet off the floor and thighs off the floor as much as possible (they may not even come off the floor when first trying this exercise. Try to create a curved C-shape with your body from your feet to you head.

ALWAYS squeeze your glutes hard in this position to protect your lower back and build strength.

Perform for reps but as in the video, hold the top position for 2-3 seconds each rep.

You may wish to decompress your spine after performing this exercise by trying a child's pose or rag doll pose. "

Lat stretch

1 sets 60 sec

"See video for instructions and let me know if you have any questions :)"

Rest 60 sec before continuing

Elongated Exhales

1 sets 30 breaths

"Elongated exhales are an amazing way to activate your parasympathetic nervous system aka your 'rest and digest' state.

They're a simple but very effective tool you can use when you are feeling stressed/anxious to reset

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yourself, but are also great to do at the end of a workout to start the recovery process immediately by taking your body and nervous system down from its high energy state from the workout.

Cues:

Sit or lay down (If sitting find a tall spine or sit against a wall if it helps).

Close your eyes or take your gaze to a fixed spot e.g. the wall in front of you.

Focus on the sensations of breathing (eg air coming into your nose, descending down into your lungs and back out again).

For up to 10-30 rounds of breath, exhale for twice the length of your inhale.

For example you could:

- Inhale for a count of 2, exhale for a count of 4*
- Inhale for a count of 3, exhale for a count of 6*

The number is less important, it's more important that the exhale is more prolonged than the inhale. This signals to your nervous system it is okay to relax :) "

Mobility: Lower Body (Could also be done after a run session)

EXERCISE

Treadmill Power Walk

1 sets 10 min

*"*This exercise can also be substituted for any other form of moderate intensity cardio such as cycling, rowing or the cross trainer. I usually walk to the gym to do my workouts so treat that as my warmup.*"*

The purpose here is to raise your internal body temperature, elevate your heart rate and prepare to move in the workout.

It is not an essential part of the workout and should you be limited on time and feel warm and able to get straight into the rest of the warmup exercises then go for it and feel free to skip this part.

"

Toe stretch

1 sets 10-20 reps

"Use a support like a bench or pole to hold onto and keep you stable. As you get better, you can stop holding onto this and start to balance.

Try not to dump your weight into your knees and slam them into the floor but lightly tap the floor each rep.

Feel the stretch in your toes and pause at the bottom of each rep if the stretch feels good. "

Internal Hip Rotation Progressions (seated -> squat)

1 sets 10-20 reps

"Variation 1 - Seated version:

Cues:

Sit on floor with hands behind your hips and use this to sit your torso as upright as possible.

Legs are bent, feet on the floor. Feet can be placed slightly wider than hips.

Allow knee to come inwards down to the floor to internally rotate the leg in the hip joint. Try to limit how much your torso rotates in the direction of the stretch and get knee as close to the floor as possible. This is your femur bone rotating internally towards the floor.

Perform the rotation for 10-20 reps each side and then include a hold at the end of the set for around 30

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seconds.

You should feel the stretch in your adductors and/or hips and will likely feel some sensations in the knee. Avoid pain but tightness is fine.

Variation 2 - Hips raised version:

The same as variation 1, but you lift your hips into the air to make the exercise more intense.

Variation 3 - Perform the internal rotation from a squat position.

Variation 4 - Perform the squat variation but allow both your hips to lower to the floor and find an external rotation with the opposition hip. Use your hands or fingertips to support you.

Variation 5 - Same as variation 4 but perform without the support of your hands or fingertips on the floor.
"

Cow/cat variations

1 sets 10 reps

"Choose a variation that feels pleasant for opening up the muscles around your spine and across your back.

Inhale as you lift the chest and come into the cow position, exhale as you round the back and dome the shoulders into the cat position. "

Calf Stretch (passive -> active -> weighted)

2 sets 120 sec

"Perform the passive calves stretch for 1-2 sets (depending on time), then perform the single/double leg active stretch after for 1-2 sets (again depending on how much time you have).

Passive calves stretch: Hold for 2 minutes on each side per set.

Single or double leg active stretch: Choose one which feels better for you. Perform 5-10 hinges per set and hold a small weight whilst you do the hinges if it feels good. Once you have done the hinges, add in a hold of 10-30 seconds at the end of the set, going deeper into the stretch every exhale.

Of course if doing single legs, repeat on both sides for the same duration with the same weight.

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All information within the instructional video. "

Jefferson Curl (regular)

2 sets reps rest 90 sec

"Exercise instructions all contained in video."

Pigeon stretch (passive -> active -> weighted)

2 sets 60-120 sec rest 60 sec

"This is predominantly an external hip rotation position that stretches and strengthens the hips and glutes. It can also be great for alleviating lower back pain. It can be REALLY unpleasant to start with, but trust me it gets easier with time!"

The video provides variations, from passive to weighted active. We will get comfortable in one before progressing.

General cues that apply to all:

Hip Alignment - try to get your hips squared to the front of the mat or the way you are facing. The hip of the extended leg should be facing down towards the floor to allow for a deep hip stretch.

Spine Alignment: Keep your spine straight and elongated. Avoid rounding your back or collapsing in the upper body. If folding forward, lead with your chest.

Weight Distribution: Try to distribute your weight evenly between your hips. Avoid putting too much pressure on one side, as it may lead to an imbalanced stretch.

Modification: Depending on your flexibility, you can adjust the position of your front foot and back leg to find the most comfortable and effective stretch for your hips. Ideally you want to work towards the front leg's shin being at a 45 degree angle and when you look to your back foot, see that it is in line with the hip of the same leg and hasn't drifted out to the side too much.

For a deeper stretch, you can walk your hands forward, bringing your chest closer to the mat.

Breathing and Relaxation: Take deep, slow breaths as you hold the pigeon stretch. With each exhale, try to relax and sink deeper into the stretch, allowing your body to release tension. If doing reps, try to time each rep with your inhale/exhale. "

Frog stretch

2 sets 60-120 sec rest 90 sec

"Starting Position:

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Begin in a tabletop/all fours position on your hands and knees. Align your wrists under your shoulders and your knees under your hips.

Then slowly slide your knees apart, wider than your hips, while keeping your ankles in line with your knees.

Allow your toes to turn slightly outward.

Alignment and Engagement:

Gently press your hips back towards your heels, feeling a stretch in your inner thighs and groin.

Keep your spine neutral, maintaining a slight arch in your lower back.

Avoid excessive pressure or pushing; listen to your body and only go as far as you can comfortably.

Breathing:

Take slow and deep breaths. Inhale deeply, and as you exhale, allow your body to relax and sink further into the stretch.

Variations x3: The video shows 3 variations you can try whilst holding the position.

Variation 1: Rock hips forward and back, try to keep glutes engaged

Variation 2: Pick up one foot at the time to internally rotate at the hip and get more comfortable in the position

Variation 3: actively try to push your knees outwards to open the gap between them, doing so will engage your glute muscles. Actively push for 5 seconds, rest 5 seconds, push, rest etc. "

Good mornings (seated)

2 sets 8-10 reps rest 90 sec

"This exercise targets the lower back, hamstrings, and glutes.

Starting Position: Sit on a flat bench with your feet flat on the floor and your knees bent at approximately a 90-degree angle.

Posture: Sit up tall with a straight back and engage your core for stability.

Neutral Neck: Keep your neck in a neutral position, aligned with your spine. Avoid straining or looking up.

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Hip Hinge: Inhale and initiate the movement by hinging at your hips, pushing your buttocks backward and leaning your upper body forward.

Back Angle: Lean forward until your back starts to round, at that point come back to the starting position of the rep.

Controlled Descent: Lower your upper body in a controlled manner, feeling a stretch in your hamstrings and tension in your lower back.

Hip Extension: Exhale and use your glutes and hamstrings to return to the starting position by pushing your hips forward.

Neutral Spine: Throughout the movement, keep your spine in a neutral position, avoiding any rounding or arching of the back.

Gaze: Keep your gaze focused straight ahead or slightly downward to maintain proper alignment."

Supine twist

1 sets 60-120 sec

"Cues for one side (but perform on both sides):

Starting position: Begin by lying on your back with your legs extended and arms out to the sides, forming a "T" shape. Keep your shoulders grounded and relaxed, and your palms facing up.

Bend the knee: Bend your right knee and draw it toward your chest. Keep your left leg extended and actively pressing into the mat.

Twist your hips: Gently lower your right knee across your body toward the left side. As you do this my top tip is to scooch your hips back to the centre of where you are lying slightly, this will help you twist more in the position.

Turn your head to look in the opposite direction of your bent knee.

Relax and Breathe: Allow your body to relax into the twist. Take slow, deep breaths, and with each exhale, try to deepen the twist slightly if it feels comfortable.

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Avoid over-rotating: Be mindful not to force your knee all the way to the ground if it doesn't naturally reach there. The goal is to feel a gentle stretch without straining the spine or hips and create a 'corkscrew' twist in the spine. "

By Rory

Detailed program

Strength + Mobility: Lower Body

Treadmill Power Walk

1 sets x reps

*"*This exercise can also be substituted for any other form of moderate intensity cardio such as cycling, rowing or the cross trainer. I usually walk to the gym to do my workouts so treat that as my warmup.*"*

The purpose here is to raise your internal body temperature, elevate your heart rate and prepare to move in the workout.

It is not an essential part of the workout and should you be limited on time and feel warm and able to get straight into the rest of the warmup exercises then go for it and feel free to skip this part.

"



Leg swings

1 sets x 10 reps

"Hold onto a solid surface with one arm.

Swing legs in three directions for up to 10 reps on each leg per direction.

For the forward and side swing movements, you could throw in a hold on the final rep of 10-30 seconds, trying to lift the leg as high as you can in



[Video explanation](#)

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front of you or to the side, to build up strength in this position. If doing a hold, remember to breath and lift the foot as high as possible.

Try to keep the legs almost straight but with a slight bend.

Don't kick so hard you hurt your hamstrings or groin, start gentle and get more energetic with the movement each swing. "

Lunge rotations

1 sets x 6-10 reps

"Setup:

Adopt a lunge position on the floor and imagine a string pulling you up to the ceiling/sky from the crown of your head.

Cues:

Breathe in and as you exhale twist as far to one side as is comfortable and as you inhale come back to face the centre with your torso.

Perform 6-10 reps on one side then include the hold, again using your exhales to twist a little further as you push the back of the hand into the outer thigh. Repeat both sides. "



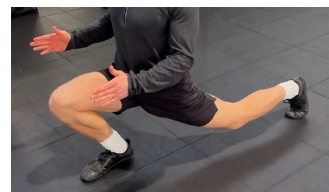
Video explanation

Superset

3 rounds

Split Squat: 3 sets x 8-10 reps (rest 90 sec)

Romanian Deadlift (barbell/dumbbell): 3 sets x 8-10



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reps (rest 90 sec)

"This superset trains two movements together in order to save time. The exercises work well together as a pair. Perform the superset for 3 sets in total. Perform each set of exercise A and B back to back with a 90 second rest between the sets. So do one set of exercise A, rest for 90 seconds do one set of exercise B, rest 90 seconds, do one set of exercise A etc.. "



Video explanation



Video explanation

Rest 90 sec before continuing

Superset

3 rounds

Wide leg squat / horse stance: 3 sets x 8-10
reps (rest 90 sec)

Cossack Squats: 3 sets x 8-10 reps (rest 90 sec)

"This superset trains two movements together in order to save time. The exercises work well together as a pair. Perform the superset for 3 sets in total. Perform each set of exercise A and B back to back with a 90 second rest between the sets. So do one set of exercise A, rest for 90 seconds do one set of exercise B, rest 90 seconds, do one set of exercise A etc.. "



Video explanation



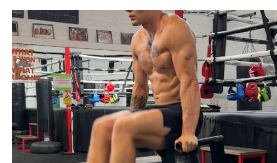
Video explanation

Rest 90 sec before continuing

Superset

2 rounds

Knee raises (bodyweight -> weighted): 2 sets x 5-20



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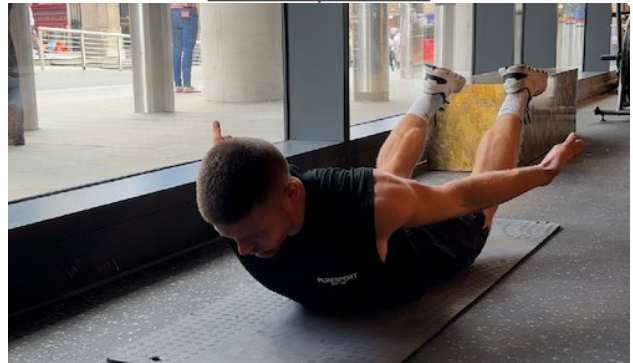
reps (rest 60 sec)

Locust pose (3 Variations): 2 sets x 8-12 reps (rest 60 sec)

"Depending on access to equipment, try to perform these two exercises b2b. "



[Video explanation](#)



[Video explanation](#)

Half Splits (dynamic)

1 sets x 120 sec

"Stretching the Hamstring:

Inhale and gently shift your hips back, hinging at your hips.

Continue to slide your front foot forward until you feel a stretch in the hamstring of the extended leg. If you feel a strong pull in the back of your knee, bend your knee slightly to reduce the strain.

Place your hands on the yoga blocks for support. You can adjust the height of the blocks to find the most comfortable and effective position.

Maintain Length in the Spine:

Lengthen your spine by reaching your chest forward and keeping your back straight.



[Video explanation](#)

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Avoid rounding your back or collapsing your chest.

Flex the foot up and down if it feels good or hold the stretch in a position of toes point forward or up to the ceiling

Relax and Breathe:

Relax into the stretch and breathe deeply. As you exhale, you may find that you can deepen the stretch slightly.

Hold one set for 30-120 seconds

"

Laying Figure 4 stretch

1 sets x 120 sec

"Leg Positioning:

Cross one ankle over the opposite knee, forming a "figure 4" shape with your legs.

Flex the foot of the leg that is elevated to protect your knee joint.

Grip:

Draw your legs towards you by either gripping the back of your thigh or your shin with fingers interlocked. At the same time keep pressing your tailbone into the floor and don't allow lower back to lift too high off the floor.

This should create a stretch in the hip and glute of the crossed leg.



[Video explanation](#)

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Personal Workout Plan

You can also gently push the knee of the crossed leg towards the floor to increase the stretch.

Repeat on both sides.

Hold stretch for 30-120 seconds.

"

Quad + hip flexor stretches

1 sets x 120 sec

"Choose the progression that feels comfortable for you and hold the stretch for up to 120 seconds per set. "



Video explanation

Elongated Exhales

1 sets x reps

"Elongated exhales are an amazing way to activate your parasympathetic nervous system aka your 'rest and digest' state.

They're a simple but very effective tool you can use when you are feeling stressed/anxious to reset yourself, but are also great to do at the end of a workout to start the recovery process immediately by taking your body and nervous system down from its high energy state from the workout.



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Cues:

Sit or lay down (If sitting find a tall spine or sit against a wall if it helps).

Close your eyes or take your gaze to a fixed spot e.g. the wall in front of you.

Focus on the sensations of breathing (eg air coming into your nose, descending down into your lungs and back out again).

For up to 10-30 rounds of breath, exhale for twice the length of your inhale.

For example you could:

- Inhale for a count of 2, exhale for a count of 4*
- Inhale for a count of 3, exhale for a count of 6*

The number is less important, it's more important that the exhale is more prolonged than the inhale.

This signals to your nervous system it is okay to relax :) "

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Cardio + Mobility: Upper Body

Assault Bike (Fan bike)

2 sets x 4 min (rest 180 sec)

*"*This can be substituted for another cardio machine at the gym if there is not an Assault Bike**

Each set consists of 4 minutes.

You will perform a 20 second sprint, followed by 10 seconds of rest, throughout the 4 minutes.

In total each set you will therefore do 8x20 seconds sprints.

In the sprints work HARD and you will build a great cardiovascular base and your anaerobic capacity will improve.

You can add extra sets if you have the energy and time. "



[Video explanation](#)

Vinyasa options (x3)

2 sets x 5 reps (rest 60 sec)

"Instructions contained in video, let me know if you have any questions :)"

Choose the option suitable for you.

Down dog cues: you are trying to create an inverted V shape with your body.

- Feet and hands about hip width apart.

- Straighten legs as much as possible sending heels towards floor. Bending knees is absolutely fine, you should feel a stretch in the backs of the legs.



[Video explanation](#)

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- *PUSH the floor away with both hands to elevate the shoulder blades and wrap you elbows in by internally rotating your shoulders (imagine squeezing an orange in your armpit) and this should help engage your lats and shoulder muscles*
- *Active fingers - if someone came to you and tried to lift your finger up from the floor they should find this difficult - this is how you know your fingers are active.*
- *Look at the space between your feet and ensure a neutral spine from top of head to base of spine. "*

Neck stretch sequence

1 sets x 5 min

"Hold each stretch for 30-60 seconds.

Be gentle with all these stretches to avoid straining your neck. "



[Video explanation](#)

Lat stretch

1 sets x 60 sec

"See video for instructions and let me know if you have any questions :)"



[Video explanation](#)

Corskcrew Shoulders



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1 sets x 20 reps

"Perform until you start to feel the a slight burn in the shoulders.

Option to add weights to the hands to make it more challenging. I recommend 1-5kg per hand.

Rotate the arm in the shoulder joint as far as it will go without pain. Each arm will be rotated the opposite way to the other each rep so you know if you're doing it correctly if you look at one arm and the palm is facing up and you look to the other arm and the palm is facing down. "



Video explanation

Shoulder dislocations

2 sets x 6-8 reps (rest 60 sec)

"A mobility exercise that helps improve shoulder flexibility and range of motion.

By moving your arms in a full circular motion you will use the full capacity of your shoulder joint.

Cues:

Try to elevate your shoulder blades as you lift up the band/bar then as you draw it behind you, retract and depress your shoulder blades.

Tip: shake out your arms between sets to help you recover for the next set."

Rest 60 sec before continuing



Video explanation

Cuban rotations

2 sets x 8-10 reps (rest 60 sec)



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"A great shoulder mobility exercise that targets the rotator cuff muscles."

Cues:

Engage Your Core: Brace your core muscles to stabilize your spine throughout the movement. Keep your torso upright and avoid arching your lower back.

Rotational Movement: As you rotate in the movement, retract your shoulder blade back. Aim to keep your elbows at shoulder height.

The emphasis with this exercise should be on maintaining proper form and control rather than using heavy weights."

Rest 60 sec before continuing

Hang (passive -> active)

2 sets x 30 sec (rest 60 sec)

"Passive hanging from a bar is a beneficial exercise for stretching and decompressing the shoulder joint and spine, improving grip strength, and promoting overall shoulder health."

Active hanging builds strength in the shoulders and upper back as well as improves overhead mobility in the shoulder flexion movement.

Variation 1: Supported passive hang. Find a bar or rings of a height that allows you to have both feet on the floor. With hands shoulder width apart, grip the bar and lower yourself into a hang position with the feet supporting you as little as possible. Be light



[Video explanation](#)



[Video explanation](#)

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on the toes so you build strength in the shoulders.

Variation 2: Make the above harder by picking up one foot so your shoulders have to work harder

Variation 3: Hang passively with both feet lifted

Variation 4: Make the hang active by bringing your knees in front of you and engage your core by adopting posterior pelvic tilt (hips and tailbone thrust forward and rounding in lower back)

Variation 5: Make this active hang harder by locking out the legs "

Rest 60 sec before continuing

Superset

2 rounds

Shoulder/upper back opener (bent arm -> straight arm) : 2 sets x 6-10 reps (rest 60 sec)

Overhead pullovers: 2 sets x 6-10 reps (rest 60 sec)

"Perform these exercises back to back with 60 secs rest between each set. "



[Video explanation](#)



[Video explanation](#)

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Shoulder stretch sequence

1 sets x reps

"This sequence contains 5 shoulder stretches that you can try and choose the ones that feel very beneficial."

Complete sequence in full for 1-2 sets. Hold each stretch for 30-120 seconds depending on time.

Let me know if you have any questions :) "



[Video explanation](#)

By Rory

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Run 2 (Interval session)

Superset

1 round

Leg swings : 1 sets x 10 reps

Hip Hinges: 1 sets x 10 reps

Split Squat: 1 sets x 10 reps

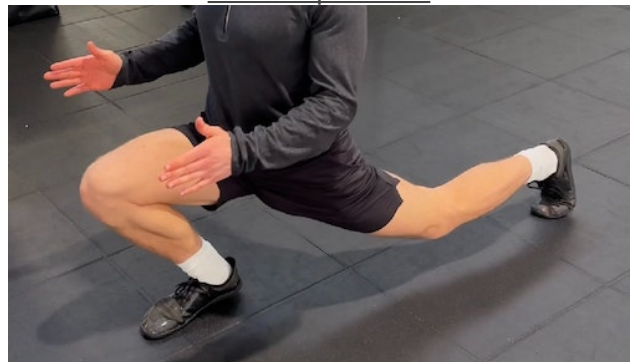
"Perform bodyweight variations of these exercises as a warmup before your run. "



[Video explanation](#)



[Video explanation](#)

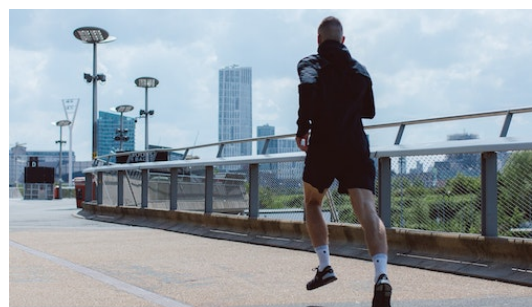


[Video explanation](#)

Running

5 sets x 800 m (rest 120 sec)

"5 efforts of 800m with a 2 minute rest. You can either rest completely or adopt a slower run to recover. Try to find a nice route or better still a park or area with grass to do this on. Alternatively you



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could use a treadmill, ideally a curved running machine at the gym.



[Video explanation](#)

Each session you can add 100m to each set:

Session 1: 5x800m (4km total)

Session 2: 5x900m (4.5km total)

Session 3: 5x1km (5km total)

Session 4: 5x1.1km (5.5km total)

Session 5: 5x1.2km (6km total)"

Superset

1 round

Laying Figure 4 stretch : 1 sets x 10-15 breaths

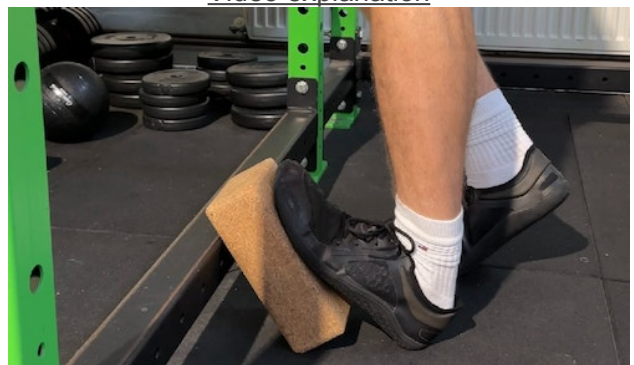
Calf Stretch (passive -> active -> weighted): 1 sets x 15 breaths

Leg lift hamstring stretch (weighted and non-weighted): 1 sets x 15 breaths

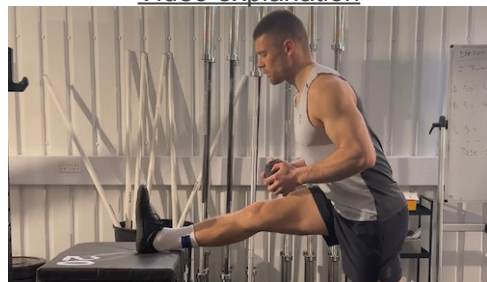
"Post run stretch to open up the body"



[Video explanation](#)



[Video explanation](#)



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[Video explanation](#)

By Rory

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Strength + Mobility: Upper Body

Treadmill Power Walk

1 sets x 10 min

*"*This exercise can also be substituted for any other form of moderate intensity cardio such as cycling, rowing or the cross trainer. I usually walk to the gym to do my workouts so treat that as my warmup.*"*

The purpose here is to raise your internal body temperature, elevate your heart rate and prepare to move in the workout.

It is not an essential part of the workout and should you be limited on time and feel warm and able to get straight into the rest of the warmup exercises then go for it and feel free to skip this part.

"

Rest 30 sec before continuing

Wrist mobility (9 movements)

1 sets x 2 min

"The instructional video is an overview of a wrist mobility and stretch sequence containing 9 variations.

Depending on your wrist strength and mobility different variations will feel more/less challenging.

I recommend choosing 2-5 of these movements and performing them in one go, spending 20-60 seconds performing each of the chosen wrist exercises, depending on how they feel.

For those with a dynamic movement (e.g. wrist



[Video explanation](#)

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rocks with fists clenched or palm lifts), move GENTLY though the movement. To make them harder, lean you shoulders more forwards to add the intensity of demand onto your wrists.

To finish or within the set, shake out your hands and avoid creating any pain in your wrists.

Remember, this is a WARM-UP, not a workout. Do enough to warm up and stretch your wrist, but not enough to hurt or fatigue them. You don't want them tired before you train.

You just want strength, mobility, and warmth."
Rest 30 sec before continuing

Cow/cat variations

1 sets x 20 breaths

"Choose a variation that feels pleasant for opening up the muscles around your spine and across your back. "



[Video explanation](#)

Rest 30 sec before continuing

Spinal rotation movements (dynamic + passive)

1 sets x 10 reps

"Choose a variation that feels good and remember to perform on both sides.

Combine repetitions with a hold in the twist position of 15-30 seconds at the end of the set if it feels comfortable.



[Video explanation](#)

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Twist further on your exhales. "

Rest 30 sec before continuing

Scapula movements

1 sets x 40 reps

"Perform these movements for up to 10 reps per movement (so up to 40 total):

Retraction

Protraction

Elevation

Depression

"

Rest 30 sec before continuing

Hanging shrugs

1 sets x 10 reps

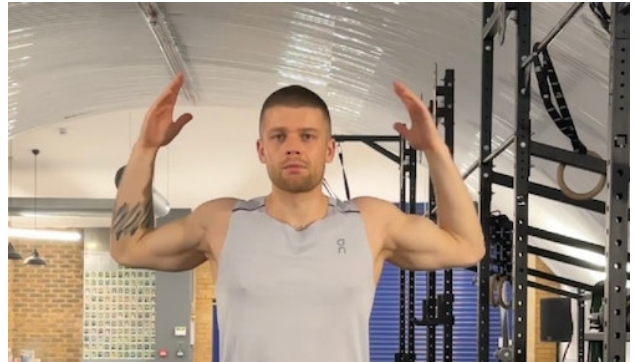
"Starting Position:

Hang from a pull-up bar or rings with an overhand grip (palms facing away from you).

Allow your body to fully extend, and your feet should not touch the ground. HOWEVER If this exercise is too challenging to perform with feet off the floor, you should place a small step or box under you and place your toes or feet onto it JUST enough to support you in the position as you do the shrugs. Try to use as little support from the feet as possible so you build your strength in your shoulders.

Engage Core and Maintain Body Alignment:

Tilt your pelvis forwards (anterior tilt) to engage core and build shoulder mobility.



[Video explanation](#)



[Video explanation](#)

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Maintain a straight body alignment from head to heels. Avoid excessive swinging or arching of your back.

Initiate the Movement:

Begin the exercise by actively pulling your shoulder blades down and back.

Imagine you are trying to squeeze a pen between your shoulder blades.

Shrug Movement:

Reverse the movement by elevating your shoulder blades towards your ears, contracting your upper back muscles.

Keep your arms straight throughout the movement.

Avoid fully relaxing your shoulders at the bottom to maintain tension on the muscles.

Focus on the muscles in your upper back to lift and lower your shoulder blades."

Rest 30 sec before continuing

Superset 1

3 rounds

Push ups variations (incline -> dumbbell -> rings): 3 sets x 8-10 reps (rest 90 sec)

Bodyweight Row -> Arc Rows: 3 sets x 8-10 reps (rest 90 sec)

"This superset trains a push and pull movement together in order to save time. The exercises work well together as a pair because they work



[Video explanation](#)



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antagonistic muscle groups. As your muscles used in the push movement recover, you perform the pull movement and vis versa. Perform the superset for 3 sets in total. Perform each set of exercise A and B back to back with a 90 second rest between the sets. So do one set of exercise A, rest for 90 seconds do one set of exercise B, rest 90 seconds, do one set of exercise A etc.. "
Rest 60 sec before continuing

Superset 2

3 rounds

Single arm dumbbell press : 3 sets x 8-10 reps (rest 90 sec)

Pull up + chin up progressions: 3 sets x 8-10 reps (rest 90 sec)

"This superset trains a push and pull movement together in order to save time. The exercises work well together as a pair because they work antagonistic muscle groups. As your muscles used in the push movement recover, you perform the pull movement and vis versa. Perform the superset for 3 sets in total. Perform each set of exercise A and B back to back with a 90 second rest between the sets. So do one set of exercise A, rest for 90 seconds do one set of exercise B, rest 90 seconds, do one set of exercise A etc.. "
Rest 90 sec before continuing

Locust pose (3 Variations)

2 sets x 8-10 reps (rest 90 sec)

"Lay flat on your front and choose one of the three variations to perform.

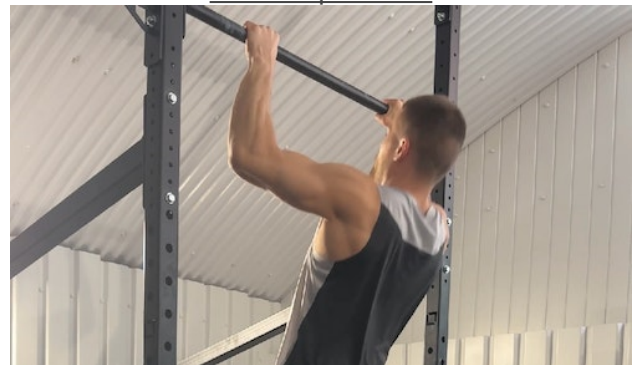
The variations get more intense each time, but



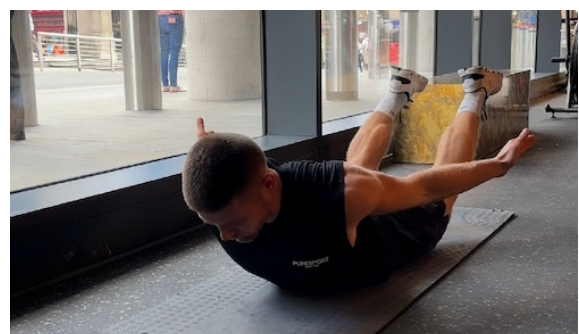
Video explanation



Video explanation



Video explanation



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choose one in which you feel suites the intensity required to strengthen your lower and upper back.



[Video explanation](#)

Variation 1: arms extended behind you with thumbs facing up (shoulders in external rotation)

Variation 2: arms bent at 90 degrees, thumbs facing the sky, retract shoulder blades as you lift up.

Variation 3: arms extended ahead of you with thumbs facing up

Cues for all variations:

1. Take a breath in and as you breathe out lift your chest as high as you can and lift your feet off the floor and thighs off the floor as much as possible (they may not even come off the floor when first trying this exercise. Try to create a curved C-shape with your body from your feet to you head.

ALWAYS squeeze your glutes hard in this position to protect your lower back and build strength.

Perform for reps but as in the video, hold the top position for 2-3 seconds each rep.

You may wish to decompress your spine after performing this exercise by trying a child's pose or rag doll pose. "

Lat stretch

1 sets x 60 sec



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"See video for instructions and let me know if you have any questions :)"



Video explanation

Rest 60 sec before continuing

Elongated Exhales

1 sets x 30 breaths

"Elongated exhales are an amazing way to activate your parasympathetic nervous system aka your 'rest and digest' state.

They're a simple but very effective tool you can use when you are feeling stressed/anxious to reset yourself, but are also great to do at the end of a workout to start the recovery process immediately by taking your body and nervous system down from its high energy state from the workout.

Cues:

Sit or lay down (If sitting find a tall spine or sit against a wall if it helps).

Close your eyes or take your gaze to a fixed spot e.g. the wall in front of you.

Focus on the sensations of breathing (eg air coming into your nose, descending down into your lungs and back out again).

For up to 10-30 rounds of breath, exhale for twice the length of your inhale.

For example you could:



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- Inhale for a count of 2, exhale for a count of 4
- Inhale for a count of 3, exhale for a count of 6

The number is less important, it's more important that the exhale is more prolonged than the inhale. This signals to your nervous system it is okay to relax :) "

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Mobility: Lower Body (Could also be done after a run session)

Treadmill Power Walk

1 sets x 10 min

*"*This exercise can also be substituted for any other form of moderate intensity cardio such as cycling, rowing or the cross trainer. I usually walk to the gym to do my workouts so treat that as my warmup.*"*

The purpose here is to raise your internal body temperature, elevate your heart rate and prepare to move in the workout.

It is not an essential part of the workout and should you be limited on time and feel warm and able to get straight into the rest of the warmup exercises then go for it and feel free to skip this part.

"



Toe stretch

1 sets x 10-20 reps

"Use a support like a bench or pole to hold onto and keep you stable. As you get better, you can stop holding onto this and start to balance.

Try not to dump your weight into your knees and slam them into the floor but lightly tap the floor each rep.

Feel the stretch in your toes and pause at the bottom of each rep if the stretch feels good. "



[Video explanation](#)

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Internal Hip Rotation Progressions (seated -> squat)

1 sets x 10-20 reps

"Variation 1 - Seated version:

Cues:

Sit on floor with hands behind your hips and use this to sit your torso as upright as possible.



[Video explanation](#)

Legs are bent, feet on the floor. Feet can be placed slightly wider than hips.

Allow knee to come inwards down to the floor to internally rotate the leg in the hip joint. Try to limit how much your torso rotates in the direction of the stretch and get knee as close to the floor as possible. This is your femur bone rotating internally towards the floor.

Perform the rotation for 10-20 reps each side and then include a hold at the end of the set for around 30 seconds.

You should feel the stretch in your adductors and/or hips and will likely feel some sensations in the knee. Avoid pain but tightness is fine.

Variation 2 - Hips raised version:

The same as variation 1, but you lift your hips into the air to make the exercise more intense.

Variation 3 - Perform the internal rotation from a squat position.

Variation 4 - Perform the squat variation but allow

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both your hips to lower to the floor and find an external rotation with the opposition hip. Use your hands or fingertips to support you.

Variation 5 - Same as variation 4 but perform without the support of your hands or fingertips on the floor. "

Cow/cat variations

1 sets x 10 reps

"Choose a variation that feels pleasant for opening up the muscles around your spine and across your back.

Inhale as you lift the chest and come into the cow position, exhale as you round the back and dome the shoulders into the cat position. "



[Video explanation](#)

Calf Stretch (passive -> active -> weighted)

2 sets x 120 sec

"Perform the passive calves stretch for 1-2 sets (depending on time), then perform the single/double leg active stretch after for 1-2 sets (again depending on how much time you have).

Passive calves stretch: Hold for 2 minutes on each side per set.

Single or double leg active stretch: Choose one which feels better for you. Perform 5-10 hinges per set and hold a small weight whilst you do the hinges



[Video explanation](#)

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if it feels good. Once you have done the hinges, add in a hold of 10-30 seconds at the end of the set, going deeper into the stretch every exhale.

Of course if doing single legs, repeat on both sides for the same duration with the same weight.

All information within the instructional video. "

Jefferson Curl (regular)

2 sets x reps (rest 90 sec)

"Exercise instructions all contained in video."



[Video explanation](#)

Pigeon stretch (passive -> active -> weighted)

2 sets x 60-120 sec (rest 60 sec)

"This is predominantly an external hip rotation position that stretches and strengthens the hips and glutes. It can also be great for alleviating lower back pain. It can be REALLY unpleasant to start with, but trust me it gets easier with time!"



[Video explanation](#)

The video provides variations, from passive to weighted active. We will get comfortable in one before progressing.

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General cues that apply to all:

Hip Alignment - try to get your hips squared to the front of the mat or the way you are facing. The hip of the extended leg should be facing down towards the floor to allow for a deep hip stretch.

Spine Alignment: Keep your spine straight and elongated. Avoid rounding your back or collapsing in the upper body. If folding forward, lead with your chest.

Weight Distribution: Try to distribute your weight evenly between your hips. Avoid putting too much pressure on one side, as it may lead to an imbalanced stretch.

Modification: Depending on your flexibility, you can adjust the position of your front foot and back leg to find the most comfortable and effective stretch for your hips. Ideally you want to work towards the front leg's shin being at a 45 degree angle and when you look to your back foot, see that it is in line with the hip of the same leg and hasn't drifted out to the side too much.

For a deeper stretch, you can walk your hands forward, bringing your chest closer to the mat.

Breathing and Relaxation: Take deep, slow breaths as you hold the pigeon stretch. With each exhale, try to relax and sink deeper into the stretch, allowing your body to release tension. If doing reps, try to time each rep with your inhale/exhale. "

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Frog stretch

2 sets x 60-120 sec (rest 90 sec)

"Starting Position:

Begin in a tabletop/all fours position on your hands and knees. Align your wrists under your shoulders and your knees under your hips.

Then slowly slide your knees apart, wider than your hips, while keeping your ankles in line with your knees.

Allow your toes to turn slightly outward.

Alignment and Engagement:

Gently press your hips back towards your heels, feeling a stretch in your inner thighs and groin.

Keep your spine neutral, maintaining a slight arch in your lower back.

Avoid excessive pressure or pushing; listen to your body and only go as far as you can comfortably.

Breathing:

Take slow and deep breaths. Inhale deeply, and as you exhale, allow your body to relax and sink further into the stretch.

Variations x3: The video shows 3 variations you can try whilst holding the position.

Variation 1: Rock hips forward and back, try to keep glutes engaged

Variation 2: Pick up one foot at the time to internally



[Video explanation](#)

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rotate at the hip and get more comfortable in the position

Variation 3: actively try to push your knees outwards to open the gap between them, doing so will engage your glute muscles. Actively push for 5 seconds, rest 5 seconds, push, rest etc. "

Good mornings (seated)

2 sets x 8-10 reps (rest 90 sec)

"This exercise targets the lower back, hamstrings, and glutes.

Starting Position: Sit on a flat bench with your feet flat on the floor and your knees bent at approximately a 90-degree angle.



[Video explanation](#)

Posture: Sit up tall with a straight back and engage your core for stability.

Neutral Neck: Keep your neck in a neutral position, aligned with your spine. Avoid straining or looking up.

Hip Hinge: Inhale and initiate the movement by hinging at your hips, pushing your buttocks backward and leaning your upper body forward.

Back Angle: Lean forward until your back starts to round, at that point come back to the starting position of the rep.

Controlled Descent: Lower your upper body in a

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controlled manner, feeling a stretch in your hamstrings and tension in your lower back.

Hip Extension: Exhale and use your glutes and hamstrings to return to the starting position by pushing your hips forward.

Neutral Spine: Throughout the movement, keep your spine in a neutral position, avoiding any rounding or arching of the back.

Gaze: Keep your gaze focused straight ahead or slightly downward to maintain proper alignment."

Supine twist

1 sets x 60-120 sec

"Cues for one side (but perform on both sides):

Starting position: Begin by lying on your back with your legs extended and arms out to the sides, forming a "T" shape. Keep your shoulders grounded and relaxed, and your palms facing up.

Bend the knee: Bend your right knee and draw it toward your chest.

Keep your left leg extended and actively pressing into the mat.

Twist your hips: Gently lower your right knee across your body toward the left side. As you do this my top tip is to scooch your hips back to the centre of where you are lying slightly, this will help you twist



[Video explanation](#)

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more in the position.

Turn your head to look in the opposite direction of your bent knee.

Relax and Breathe: Allow your body to relax into the twist. Take slow, deep breaths, and with each exhale, try to deepen the twist slightly if it feels comfortable.

Avoid over-rotating: Be mindful not to force your knee all the way to the ground if it doesn't naturally reach there. The goal is to feel a gentle stretch without straining the spine or hips and create a 'corkscrew' twist in the spine. "

